MERROWFIELD DIGITAL

Playbook: Cloud misconfiguration

Document Playbook 07 | Rev 3 | Effective 9 February 2026 | Owner: Security Operations | Review cycle: 12 months

1. What this playbook covers

This playbook covers data exposed through a cloud configuration error - storage readable by the public, a search index or database replica reachable from the internet, or sharing links and snapshots open to everyone. It is used by the Security Analyst who investigates, from the first alert until the incident is closed.

2. How it is usually recognised

- a cloud security posture alert
- a report from a security researcher or another third party
- a configuration scan in the deployment pipeline

3. The first hour

1. Block public access and correct the policy.
2. Rotate any access keys that were exposed.
3. Revoke open sharing links.
4. Establish the exposure window from the change log.
5. Pull the access logs to see who downloaded what, and from where.

4. Evidence to preserve

- the configuration before and after the fix
- the change record that introduced the error
- storage and database access logs for the exposure window
- correspondence with the researcher who reported it

5. Establishing the facts a report needs

Whatever is decided, the decision needs these facts, established as early as they can be:

- what was exposed and for how long
- whether anyone outside the company downloaded it - whether exfiltration is confirmed
- whether the data was protected in a way that still held once it was public
- where the storage is hosted, and how many customers in the EU and in India are affected

6. Reporting

Which reporting procedures apply is settled from the incident's facts by the rules in Plan 01, section 8, and each procedure's deadlines are read from that procedure. This playbook sets no deadline of its own, and the decision belongs to the Data Protection Officer.

Exposed storage hosted in India, or holding data of users in India, falls under Procedure 03, whose clock runs from the first alert - often the researcher's report.

7. What affected customers should do

When customers are told, the notice gives them these steps, in this order:

- Be alert to phishing that uses your name, address or order details.
- If we tell you your account details were exposed, change your password.
- Merrowfield will never ask you for your password.

8. Closing the incident

Fix the infrastructure template so the setting cannot return, add a configuration check to the pipeline, and thank the researcher.